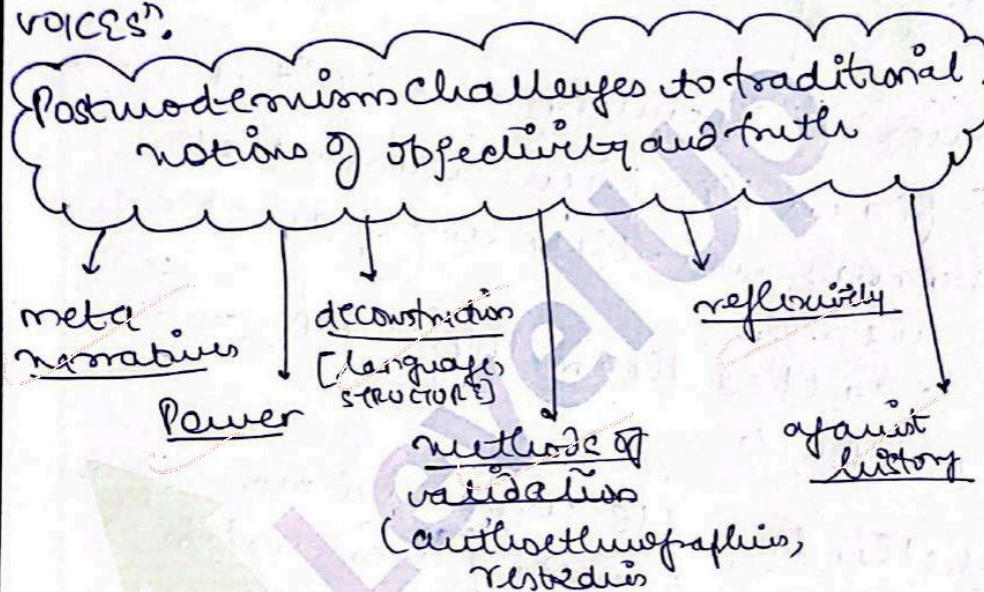


Q.6c (15 marks): How does Postmodernism challenge traditional notions of objectivity and truth in anthropological research...

i.c) How does Postmodernism challenge traditional notions of objectivity and truth in anthropological research? (15 marks)

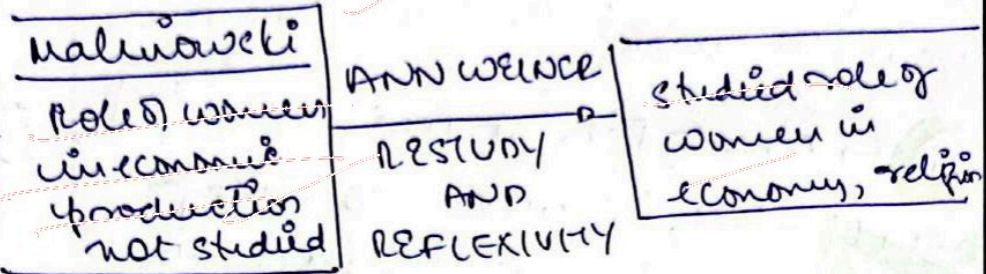
"Postmodernism" was coined by Arnold
Tynybee to denote a new way of thinking
 and attacking notion of science, reason
 and objectivity. McPine says "objectivity
 is an illusion and truth has MULTIPLE
voices".



Kutner says major tenet of Postmodernism
 is that "Culture is imperial" as it is
 ridden with western, Colonial Connotations
Challenges from Postmodernism :-

① Reflexivity :- Malinowski's writings
 reflected racist and paternalist bias
 (said ANN WELNOR). Now this is the

"Conscious self-inspection" a researcher must do in research.



Thus reflexivity takes into account researcher - gender, age, race etc.

② Autoethnography VIKTOR Grapanz in "Hermes Dilemma, Haunted Desire" says the researcher must maintain log of self awareness.

Postmodernism Questions:-

The ideals of culture $\Rightarrow$ real behaviour of culture
 $\uparrow$
 Bias of researcher

③ Metanarratives: Lyotard says that ONE UNDERLYING DEFINITION of phenomenon is not possible. Due to various local contexts and RELATIVISM - the ultimate absolute truth cannot be found.

④ Polyvocality : Post modernism says multiple truths are possible and thus objectivity and truth cannot be got.

⑤ Relation of Power and knowledge :- Foucault said "Power is 100 microprocesses in research" and thus true objectivity cannot be got.

⑥ Deconstruction and Post structuralism
Derrida in "Of Grammatology" said language can never be totally replicated through structural studies. He said texts must be deconstructed.
Derrida's method :-

Take a text → Find ambiguity → Extreme deconstruction

⑦ Against historical approach :-
They state that history cannot be objective as it is a DLUP.

Criticism of Postmodernism : Ray
Andrade says - post modernism is against science but is taking us far from near truth too. It is focusing too much on power.